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WAM

■ Motorists navigate through the rain in Abu Dhabi yesterday. Authorities urged residents to reduce speed and maintain safe distance between vehicles.

Unstable weather to persist across UAE until tomorrow

Residents urged to exercise caution as authorities step up emergency response

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Authorities in the UAE have urged residents to exercise caution as unstable weather is set to continue across the country until tomorrow.

The warning comes as the country experienced one of the most active weather spells in recent memory this week, as a surface low-pressure system combined with an upper-air low-pressure trough moved across the region. The National Centre of Meteorol-

● The country experienced one of the most active weather spells in recent memory this week.

ogy (NCM) said the combination increased cloud formation and the probability of convective rainfall over scattered areas, with conditions forecast to persist until tomorrow.

Rain, strong winds and low-pressure systems affected multiple regions yesterday, prompting safety alerts and traffic warnings.

Municipal authorities across the UAE stepped up field and emergency response measures

to address rainfall and unstable weather conditions, intensifying efforts to safeguard public facilities, maintain traffic flow and ensure the efficiency of stormwater drainage systems.

Forecasters are warning that the most significant rainfall event of the entire system is yet to come. As the low-pressure system deepens overnight, its final wave is set to originate over the western areas late today before sweeping through Al Dhafra and Abu Dhabi in the early hours of tomorrow.

On Saturday, cloud cover will decrease across the country, with northwesterly winds becoming active to strong at times, especially over the sea, accompanied by a drop in temperatures.

SEE ALSO P2

UAE banks resilient with Dh5tr in assets

Rising investments, transaction volumes reflect expansion

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

UAE banks expanded at the start of 2026, showing resilience amid regional geopolitical tensions, as assets, investments and transaction activity increased, according to central bank data.

UAE banking assets rose 1.4 per cent month-on-month to Dh5.41 trillion at the end of January, up from Dh5.34 trillion in December, reflecting continued expansion across credit and deposit activity.

Investments by banks operating in the UAE increased 2 per cent during January, rising by Dh16.9 billion to reach Dh872.3 billion by month-end. On an annual basis, investment growth reached 17.4 per cent compared to January 2025.

Data showed that banks' investments in securities representing debt on others rose to Dh418.6 billion, marking a 3.1 per cent monthly increase and 26 per cent annual

growth. Bonds held to maturity climbed to Dh371.1 billion, up 0.8 per cent from the previous month and 10.5 per cent higher year-on-year.

Equity investments rose to Dh25.2 billion, increasing 3.3 per cent month-on-month and 31.9 per cent annually, while other investments edged up 0.9 per cent to Dh57.4 billion.

Transactions rise

Banking operations data showed that transfers executed through the UAE Funds Transfer System reached approximately Dh2.08 trillion in January. Of this, around Dh1.21 trillion was carried out by banks, while customers accounted for about Dh864.6 billion. Cheque activity also increased, with the value of cheques processed using image-based systems rising to Dh125.2 billion across 1.95 million cheques during the month.

Lending activity also continued to support the banking sector, with credit growth driven mainly by the private and government sectors, even as lending to other financial institutions declined.

SEE ALSO P7

IRAN REJECTS TRUMP'S PLAN, SETS OWN TERMS

UN Council condemns Iran's 'egregious attacks'

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iran has rejected a US-backed plan to pause the war and instead issued its own set of conditions, making clear that any end to the conflict will be dictated by Tehran — not Washington.

The exchange of competing proposals highlights a widening gap between the two sides, even as backchannel diplomacy continues.

According to officials, the United States has put forward a 15-point framework that includes a one-month ceasefire to allow negotiations. The proposal — conveyed to Iran via Pakistan — calls for curbs on Tehran's nuclear and missile programmes, the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, and limits on its regional activities, in exchange for sanctions relief and civilian nuclear cooperation.

But Iran has firmly pushed back. State broadcaster Press TV, citing a senior official, said Tehran had "responded negatively" to the American plan, adding: "The end of the war will occur when Iran decides it should end, not when Trump envisions its conclusion."

Iran's counterproposal

Instead of engaging with the US framework, Iran has outlined its own conditions for

GARGASH: SUPPORT FALLS SHORT

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has called for clearer and more decisive positions from sisterly and friendly countries amid the ongoing escalation, saying recent developments have exposed a gap between genuine support and statements without action.

In a post on his X account, Gargash said: "Since the start of the Iranian aggression, friendly and allied countries had reached out, but their responses varied between sincere, tangible support and positions limited to rhetoric."

He stressed that the UAE has demonstrated its ability to navigate challenges and remain resilient, adding that the country does not rely on numbers or resources as much as it values clarity of positions and knowing who can be relied upon in times of crisis.

—Khitam Al Amir, Chief News Editor

ending the war. According to state media, these are: A complete halt to attacks and targeted killings of Iranian officials; guarantees that the war will not be reimposed; reparations for damages caused by the conflict; a full end to hostilities across all fronts, including regional allies and international recognition of Iran's sovereignty over the Strait of Hormuz.

Seeking comprehensive end

Iranian officials have repeatedly stressed they are not seeking a temporary ceasefire, but a comprehensive end to the war on their own terms.

Despite US President Donald Trump's claims of progress, Iranian officials insist that no negotiations — direct or indirect — are currently taking place.

Even as diplomatic channels remain active, the battlefield tells a different story. Iran said it had launched cruise missiles at the USS Abraham Lincoln, while Israeli strikes continued on targets inside Iran. Attacks have spread across the region, hitting sites in Lebanon, Bahrain, Kuwait, Jordan and Saudi Arabia.

The UN Human Rights Council yesterday condemned Iran's "egregious attacks" on its Gulf neighbours and demanded full reparations for victims.

The UAE said it had intercepted more than 2,000 Iranian ballistic missiles and drones, with its ambassador Jamal Al Musharakh insisting: "We have never allowed the use of our airspace for attacks against Iran."

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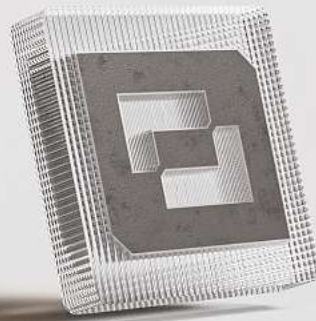
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